



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Classical Schools
School Website: <http://libertyclassicalschoools.org>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Liberty Classical Schools Georgia (GA 30082) presents a robust classical-education model grounded in liberal arts, Great Books, and historically oriented pedagogy. Public-facing materials emphasize virtues, character formation, a story-rich history curriculum, and a time-tested liberal arts approach, all of which align strongly with core classical education tenets such as truth, virtue, and beauty, as well as the Great Conversation. The school clearly showcases liberal-arts content, Socratic inquiry, and a deliberate focus on forming virtuous citizens. Evidence of parental partnership and community-building further reinforces classical aims, though explicit liturgical/theological practices are less visible in the public materials.

Overall, the school demonstrates strong classical alignment across most rubric categories, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 5 (Faculty) showing more modest alignment than Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations), Element 2 (Purpose and Goal), Element 3 (Curriculum), and Element 6 (Parents & Community), which are more fully classical. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on evidence and analysis are drawn from Liberty Classical Schools public materials (About Us, Home, Curriculum, What We Teach, Great Conversation references, leadership and outreach pages) and from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) knowledge base, which provides the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators used for scoring. See cited sources for specific language and keyword indicators.

- Foundational ideas and phrases such as truth, virtue, Great Books, Great Conversation, and Socratic inquiry appear in Liberty's materials, demonstrating alignment with core classical concepts (e.g., Truth, Virtue, Great Conversation; Socratic pedagogy). See: About Us (turn0file0), Home (turn0file2), Curriculum (turn0file5), and What We Teach (turn0file1).
- The school's explicit emphasis on forming virtuous citizens, "Training the Mind, Strengthening the Heart," and a time-tested liberal arts curriculum aligns with classical purposes and goals. See About Us and Home statements (turn0file2, turn0file0).
- Parental and community engagement is evident through Outreach pages, Pillars of Liberty, and resources for families, indicating strong Parents & Community alignment. See Community Outreach, Pillars of Liberty, and Express Interest/Find a Location materials (turn0file9, turn0file10).

ABSTRACT

of Category-level scoring results (below) is grounded in keyword analysis using the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements document.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize the cultivation of virtues and moral formation, including a list of virtues (Courage, Courtesy, Honesty, Humility, Perseverance, Self-Government, Service) and the idea that character pervades the curriculum. This evokes transcendental moral realism and virtue-oriented aims.
- References to “philosophic truth” and to Socrates appear, indicating engagement with classical philosophical ideals and true/ethical inquiry.
- The curriculum and materials foreground Great Books and Great Conversation as organizing ideas, reflecting the belief in real truths accessible through study and dialogue.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, virtue, moral formation, character development, great conversation, Socrates, philosophy of virtue.
- Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no explicit values-neutral or relativistic framings found in the public-facing pages). The Six Elements document cautions about opposite trends, but the Liberty materials do not demonstrate those sequences.

Why this rating

- The presence of transcendent, virtue-centered aims and explicit engagement with philosophical truth (including Socratic thought) strongly aligns with Classical education’s Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. Theology-focused liturgical practices are not evident in the public materials, but the transcendental moral realism and engagement with Great Conversations indicate classical alignment, yielding CLASSICAL for Element 1.
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Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission explicitly states forming knowledgeable, virtuous citizens, underscoring formation and character development as central goals rather than job preparation.
- Language such as “Training the Mind, Strengthening the Heart” frames education as a formation project—aligning with virtue and wisdom as real goods.
- The Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis reinforces the aim of cultivating wisdom and virtue through classical inquiry rather than mere information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtuous citizens, formation, virtue, truth, wisdom, Great Conversation, character development.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public statements (no explicit job-prep or skills-only framing). The presence of formation-focused language supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The school prioritizes virtue formation and the pursuit of true goods over narrow job-prep aims, consistent with Classical objectives for human excellence. CLASSICAL is justified for Element 2.
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Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is described as liberal arts-based and time-tested, with explicit emphasis on the Great Books and Great Conversation. The structure explicitly references grammar, logic, and rhetoric as a progression, and includes Latin studies and a story-rich history curriculum.
- Great Books, Great Conversation, and the traditional liberal-arts sequence are repeatedly named (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history as organizing outline). This mirrors standard classical-curriculum expectations.
- The site indicates a historical, text-rich approach and a focus on core liberal arts disciplines (reading, writing, literature, mathematics, science, history, Latin).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Great Books, Great Conversation, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, story-rich history, liberal arts.
- Negative keywords: not evident in the public-facing curriculum materials; no strong anti-tradition or relativistic framing observed.

Why this rating

- The explicit articulation of grammar-logic-rhetoric progression, Great Books/Great Conversation, and a liberal-arts foundation strongly aligns with Element 3's Curriculum criteria. CLASSICAL is warranted.
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Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- There is explicit reference to Socratic questioning as a central mechanism for deepening understanding and for encouraging students to articulate their reasoning ("why" and "so what"). This is a hallmark of classical pedagogy in the upper grades.
- The curriculum describes upper-school seminars, debates, and rhetoric training as components of pedagogy, signaling incorporation of Socratic and rhetorical methods.
- There is a general emphasis on a combination of rigorous inquiry with opportunities for memory, recitation, and contemplation in classical pedagogy, though lower-level material on singing/chanting is not explicitly documented in public materials. The general approach is to blend rigorous inquiry with reflective practice but with less public detail on lower-school singing or contemplative/restful pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic, seminars, debates, rhetoric, Great Conversation, memory/recitation (implied in grammar-logic-rhetoric progression).
- Negative keywords: not evident in public postings; no explicit statements about value-neutral pedagogy or exclusively project-based/experimental teaching in the public content. The absence of certain "restful/contemplative" phrasing is noted but not overtly negative.

Why this rating

- The presence of Socratic discussion and rhetoric-focused training demonstrates classical pedagogy in key elements, but explicit statements about lower-school contemplative/restful pedagogy and full articulation of all six pedagogical modes (restful, memory-based, Socratic, seminars, etc.) are not as explicit as the strongest classical exemplars. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The site emphasizes mission-driven leadership, dedicated development teams, and a leadership fellowship program, indicating a culture that values trained, knowledgeable educators and leaders. This suggests faculty quality and ongoing development, though not every line item in the rubric (e.g., a stated “living curriculum” portrait) is explicitly claimed in public content.
- Public pages highlight leadership roles and the “team” driving the Liberty network, with several personnel biographies and development roles. This demonstrates a professional staff structure.
- The explicit articulation of virtue-centered teaching is present (virtues, pillars of character) but there is less explicit language about teachers as “models of virtue” or a formal “portrait of teacher and student” in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtuous teachers as a concept in spirit (virtue-centered pedagogy) and leadership training for school leaders.
- Negative keywords: explicit statements about teachers being “the living curriculum” or a formal teacher-portrait are not visible in public pages, which weighs slightly against a full CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates strong faculty quality through mission-oriented leadership and development pathways, but the lack of explicit, published language about teachers as the living curriculum or a formal teacher-student portrait reduces to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
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Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The school actively positions itself as partnered with families and communities, including outreach programs and opportunities for parents to participate in Pillars of Liberty and related fundraising/community initiatives. This includes explicit calls for parent involvement in starting new Liberty schools and ongoing outreach activities.
- Several pages describe opportunities for families to engage (Expression of Interest, Find a Location, Community Outreach, and resources for parents). The organization explicitly frames parents as co-teachers or partners in classical education and asks for parental participation and visits.
- The organization provides materials aimed at educating parents about classical education (Virtue Cards, resources) and invites parents to remain engaged via events and communications.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent education, visits for parents, community outreach, Pillars of Liberty, ambassadors program.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit callouts to minimize parental involvement or restrict access). The absence of negative indicators supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Why this rating

- Liberty’s content demonstrates strong parent-company collaboration and active community involvement, aligning with Element 6’s expectations for classical schooling.
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What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were to strengthen toward a fully classical model, focusing on explicit articulation of the “living curriculum” role of faculty (Element 5) would move the needle. Publicly stating how faculty embody virtues, mentor students, and model classical dispositions could elevate Element 5 to CLASSICAL.
- Increasing explicit articulation of liturgical/theological integration (Element 1) where appropriate, or clearly delineating why theology is or isn’t part of the curriculum, would further clarify Foundation alignment for readers who expect theological grounding in some classical models.

Note: No major needle-moving changes are required given the overall CLASSICAL rating, but explicit statements in Element 5 and enhanced articulation of liturgical/theological alignment would push all six categories toward stronger CLASSICAL consistency.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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